

MECONOPSIS

basal rosettes and in decreasing size up flowering stems. Bears clusters of cup-shaped, bright blue, sometimes white or purple-blue, flowers in early summer. Z5–7. **var. alba** (illus. p.218), H 4–5ft (1.2–1.5m), S 1½–2ft (45–60cm), has pure white flowers. ***M. betonicifolia* of gardens.** See *M. baileyi*. ***M. cambrica.*** See *Papaver cambricum*. ***M. x cookei ‘Old Rose’*** (illus. p.218). Clump-forming, long-lived perennial. H 1½ft (45cm), S 1ft (30cm). Produces numerous pendent, cup-shaped, deep pink flowers in late spring and early summer. Has basal rosettes of ovate to oblong, bristly, mid-green leaves. Does not produce viable seed. Z5–7 ***M. Fertile Blue Group ‘Lingholm’*** (illus. p.218). Clump-forming perennial. H 4–5ft (1.2–1.5m), S 1½–2ft (45–60cm). In early summer, bears clusters of shallow cup-shaped, sky-blue flowers. Has rosettes of oblong to ovate to lance-shaped, slightly toothed, hairy, mid-green leaves. Divide every 3 years to maintain vigor. Z5–7 ***M. grandis*** (Himalayan blue poppy; illus. p.218). Erect perennial. H 3–5ft (1–1.5m), S 1ft (30cm). Has basal rosettes of oblong, slightly toothed, hairy, mid-green leaves. In early summer, stout stems bear slightly nodding, cup-shaped, deep blue flowers. Z5–7 ***M. Infertile Blue Group ‘Crewdson Hybrid’*** (illus. p.218). Clump-forming, long-lived perennial. H 3–4ft (1–1.2m), S 1½–2ft (45–60cm). In early summer bears clusters of funnel- to cup-shaped, clear deep blue flowers. Has rosettes of oblong, hairy, mid-green leaves with a brownish tinge and scalloped edges. Z5–7 ***M. Infertile Blue Group ‘Slieve Donard’*** (illus. p.218). Clump-forming, long-lived perennial. H 4–5ft (1.2–1.5m), S 1½–2ft (45–60cm). In early summer, bears clusters of shallow, cup-shaped, sky-blue flowers. Has rosettes of oblong to ovate, hairy, mid-green leaves with marginal teeth absent or very few and tiny. Fertile seed is not produced. Z5–7 ***M. integrifolia.*** Monocarpic, deciduous perennial. H 1½–2ft (45–60cm), S 2ft (60cm). Bears spikes of large, cup-shaped, pale yellow flowers from late spring to midsummer. Has rosettes of large, linear to oblong, hairy, pale green leaves. Z5–7 ***M. George Sherriff Group ‘Jimmy Bayne’*** (illus. p.218). Rhizomatous, long-lived perennial. H to 5ft (1.5m), S 1½–2ft (45–60cm). In early summer, bears clusters of shallowly bowl-shaped flowers, deep blue or with a purplish tinge. Has rosettes of ovate to lance-shaped, hairy, mid-green leaves, edged with rounded teeth. Z5–7 ***M. ‘Marit’*** (illus. p.218). Clump-forming, long-lived perennial. H 4–5ft (1.2–1.5m), S 1½–2ft (45–60cm). In early summer, bears clusters of cup-shaped, white to pale creamy-white flowers. Has rosettes of oblong to lance-shaped, hairy, mid-green leaves with regular and neatly toothed edges. Divide every 3 years to maintain vigor. Seed is not produced. Z5–7 ***M. napaulensis of gardens*** (illus. p.218). Clump-forming, short-lived perennial that dies after flowering. H 5ft (1.5m), S 2ft (60cm). Produces sprays of nodding, shallowly cup-shaped, yellow, pink, red, or white flowers from late spring to midsummer. Bears large rosettes of oblong

to lance-shaped, deeply lobed and cut, hairy, yellowish-green leaves. Z5–7 ***M. quintuplinervia*** (Harebell poppy). Mat-forming, deciduous perennial. H 1–1½ft (30–45cm), S 1ft (30cm). Cup-shaped, nodding, lavender-blue flowers, deepening to purple at the bases, are borne singly on hairy stems, from late spring to late summer, above a dense mat of large, oblong to lance-shaped, mid-green leaves. Seed is very difficult to germinate. Z5–7

MEDICAGO

Medick
PAPILIONACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE
Genus of annuals, perennials, and evergreen shrubs, grown for their pealike flowers. Very wind resistant; good in mild, coastal areas. Fully hardy to frost hardy, but in cold areas plant against a warm, sunny wall. Requires sun and well-drained soil. Cut out dead wood in spring. Propagate shrubs by semiripe or softwood cuttings in summer, or by seed in fall or spring; annuals and perennials by seed in fall or spring. ***M. arborea*** (Moon trefoil). Evergreen, bushy, dense shrub. H and S 6ft (2m). Bears clusters of small, pealike, yellow flowers from mid-spring to early fall, followed by curious, flattened, snaillike, green, then brown seed pods. Has dark green leaves, each with 3 narrowly triangular leaflets that are silky-haired when young. Z4–10

MEDINILLA

MELASTOMATACEAE
Genus of evergreen shrubs and scrambling climbers, some epiphytic, grown for their flowers and foliage. Frost tender. Needs partial shade and humus-rich, well-drained soil. Water potted plants freely when in full growth, moderately at other times. Propagate by greenwood cuttings in spring or summer. ***M. magnifica*** illus. p.455.

MEEHANIA

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE
Genus of clump-forming perennials with creeping stems, grown mainly as groundcover. Fully hardy. Prefers shade and well-drained, but not dry, humus-rich soil. May be propagated by seed, division, or stem cuttings in spring. ***M. urticifolia.*** Clump-forming, spreading perennial with long, creeping, leafy stems. H to 1ft (30cm), S indefinite. Ovate to triangular, toothed leaves are 4in (10cm) or more long on creeping stems—smaller on flowering stems. Whorls of fragrant, 2-lipped, purplish-blue flowers, to 2in (5cm) long, are borne in erect spikes in late spring and early summer. Z4–8

Megasea. See *Bergenia*.

MELALEUCA

Paperbark
MYRTACEAE
Genus of evergreen, spring- and summer-flowering trees and shrubs, grown for their flowers and overall appearance.

Frost hardy to frost tender. Needs full light and well-drained soil, preferably without much nitrogen. Some species tolerate waterlogged soils. Water containerized specimens moderately, less in low temperatures. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer. ***M. alternifolia*** (Tea tree). Large, bushy shrub or small tree. H 20ft (6m), S 12ft (4m). Has papery, gray-white bark and linear, smooth, mid-green leaves scattered irregularly or whorled on the stems. In summer, bears small, white flowers in dense spikes, 1¼–2in (3–5cm) long, followed by small, woody, cup-shaped fruits. Source of tea tree oil. Z9–11 ***M. armillaris*** (Bracelet honey myrtle). Evergreen, rounded, wiry-stemmed shrub or tree. H 10–20ft (3–6m), S 4–10ft (1.2–3m). Has needlelike, deep green leaves and, in summer, dense, bottlebrushlike clusters, 1¼–2½in (3–6cm) long, each flower a small brush of white stamens. Z10–11 ***M. hypericifolia.*** Evergreen, rounded shrub or small tree. H and S 6–15ft (2–5m). Leaves are oblong to ovate and mid- to deep green above, paler beneath. Produces crimson flowers, comprising a ¾–1in (2–2.5cm) long brush of stamens of the same color, from spring to summer, mainly in bottlebrushlike spikes, 1½–3in (4–8cm) long. Z9–11 ***M. squarrosa*** (Scented paperbark). Evergreen, erect, wiry-stemmed shrub or tree. H 10–20ft (3–6m), S 6–12ft (2–4m). Has tiny, ovate, deep green leaves. Bears 1½in (4cm) long spikes of scented flowers, each comprising a tiny brush of cream stamens, in late spring and summer. Z9–11

MELAMPODIUM

ASTERACEAE
Genus of perennials useful for hanging baskets, containers, and summer bedding. Frost-tender. Prefers full sun in well-drained soil. Propagate by seed *in situ* in spring or early fall. ***M. montanum AZTEC GOLD ‘Starbini’***, *syn. Sanvitalia AZTEC GOLD* of gardens. Trailing perennial. H to 5in (12cm). Dark reddish-brown stems carry paired mid-green, lance-shaped leaves with bristly upper surfaces. From early summer to early fall, bears small, bright yellow, daisylike flowers at the stem tips. Z8–11

MELASTOMA

MELASTOMATACEAE
Genus of evergreen, mainly summer-flowering shrubs and trees, and a few perennials, grown for their flowers and foliage. Frost tender. Requires full light or partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil. Water containerized specimens freely in full growth, moderately at other times. Pruning is tolerated in late winter if needed. Propagate by seed in spring or softwood or greenwood cuttings in summer. Whitefly and red spider mite may cause problems. ***M. candidum.*** Evergreen, rounded, bristly-stemmed shrub. H and S 3–6ft (1–2m). Has ovate, leathery, bristly leaves and bears profuse small, terminal clusters of fragrant, 5–7-petaled, white or pink flowers in summer. Z11–12 (min. 55°F/13°C)

MELIA

MELIACEAE
Genus of deciduous or semievergreen spring-flowering trees and shrubs, grown for their foliage, flowers and fruits. Useful for very dry soil and does well in coastal gardens in mild areas. Frost tender. Needs a site in full sun; grows in any well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in spring. ***M. azedarach*** (Bead-tree, Persian lilac) illus. p.71.

MELIANTHUS

MELIANTHACEAE
Genus of evergreen shrubs, grown mainly for their foliage. Frost hardy to frost tender. Grow in a border or as specimen plants; they are particularly well suited to coastal gardens. Requires sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Water containerized specimens freely in summer, moderately at other times. Long stems may be shortened in early spring. Propagate by seed in spring or by greenwood cuttings in late spring or early summer. Red spider mite may be troublesome. ***M. major*** (Honeybush) illus. p.145.

MELICA

Melick
POACEAE/GRAMINEAE
See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES. ***M. altissima*** (Siberian melic). Evergreen, tuft-forming, perennial grass. H 2ft (60cm), S 8in (20cm). Produces slender stems and pointed, linear, pale to mid-green leaves, rough beneath, 4–9in (10–23cm) long. In summer, pendent, green spikelets are produced in narrow, erect, one-sided panicles, 4–10in (10–25cm) long with densely flowered tips. Z4–8. ***‘Atropurpurea’*** illus. p.286.

MELICYTUS

SYN. HYMENANTHERA
VIOLACEAE
Genus of evergreen or semievergreen shrubs, grown for their overall appearance and ornamental fruits. Borderline fully hardy to frost tender. Requires a position in full light or partial shade and in well-drained soil. Needs long, hot summers to flower and fruit well. Water potted plants moderately, less in winter. Pruning is tolerated if required. Propagate by seed in spring or semiripe cuttings in summer. ***M. crassifolius***, *syn. Hymenanthera crassifolia.* Evergreen, densely twiggy shrub of irregular outline. H and S to 4ft (1.2m). Bears narrowly ovate to oblong, leathery, mid-green leaves. Bears tiny, bell-shaped, 5-petaled, yellow flowers in late spring and early summer, followed by egg-shaped, purple fruits. Z5–9 ***M. ramiflorus*** (Mahoe, Whiteywood). Evergreen, spreading shrub or tree. H and S 20–30ft (6–10m). Bark is grayish-white. Has lance-shaped, bluntly serrated, bright green leaves. In summer, bears small, rounded, greenish flowers in axillary clusters, followed by tiny, violet to purple-blue berries. Z9–11